

March

9

1842

Golden dreams

Legend has it that Francisco Lopez fell asleep under a tree in Placerita Canyon and dreamed he was floating in a golden pool. When he woke, he pulled out some wild onions from the ground and found gold flakes on their roots. His find was recorded as the first gold discovery in California, USA.



Born this day

1979 Oscar Isaac, Guatemalan-American actor. He played Poe Dameron in the *Star Wars* films and Apocalypse in the *X-Men* movies.



1959

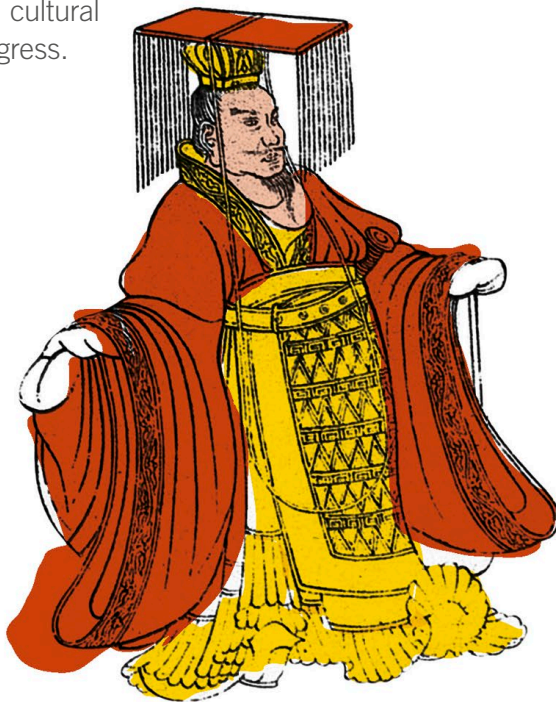
Barbie doll

Named after the inventor's daughter, the Barbie doll was revealed at the New York toy fair. Based on a German doll called Bild Lilli, Barbie has been updated over the years to match changing fashions.

Teenage emperor

141 BCE

Liu Che became emperor of China at the age of 16, founding the Han Dynasty. He reigned for the next 54 years during a period of great political, military, and cultural progress.



Also on this day

1009 The name **Lithuania** was first written down in a book by monks at the Quedlinburg Abbey in Germany.

1945 Forty-eight hours of bombing raids on Tokyo by US warplanes began. The city was badly damaged and more than 80,000 people were killed.

2005 A third gender option of "eunuch" was added to Indian passports in recognition of the country's *hijra* community.